



Apple's significant drop in innovation

Apple has fallen from 1st spot last year to a whopping 17th spot on Fast Company's 'most innovative companies' list for 2019. <https://digit.in/mar19-26>



iOS 13 might remove Volume HUD

Apple may finally fix the pesky and obtrusive volume HUD that annoyingly sits right in the centre of the screen. <https://digit.in/mar19-27>

FANDOMS AND FAN LABOUR

The participatory nature of fandoms has led to different kinds of activities emerging within these communities.

Fans engage with others in the community through various kinds of fan activities. This may involve dressing up as one of the characters (cosplay), writing stories set in the same universe (fan fiction), painting interpretations of characters (fan art), or discussing the stories in depth (meta-discussion). While there is significant overlap of these activities across all fandoms, particular activities have emerged around some franchises which are suitable for that kind of fan labour. While traditionally these activities could only be found on conventions, the advance of technologies has allowed for more people around the world to engage in, and share these activities. Change.org for example, seems to attract an inordinate number of petitions from DCEU fans. Here are some of the activities that are most suitable to their fandoms.

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in



MIDDLE EARTH: LANGUAGES

Tolkien changed modern fantasy as we know it, bringing about a familiar medieval universe with elves, orcs and dwarves. Fantasy before Tolkien was very similar to fairy tales. In his storytelling, Tolkien used the approach of reconstruction used by linguists. Tolkien also wrote the stories around multiple languages, complete with their own histories. Considering the richness of these constructed languages, Ringers or Tolkienites like to learn the languages, speak in them, and use the various scripts. The elvish languages of Quenya and Sindarin are popular for speaking, while the Tengwar and Cirth scripts are used by those who like to write.

ASOIAF: METADISCUSSIONS

A Song of Ice and Fire is custom made for meta discussions, which can get pretty heated. At times, fans will even reach out to GRRM to get inputs on particular contentious topics – such as if lemon trees can grow in Braavos, and where Dany spent her childhood. These discussions involve critical reading, following up the arcs of individual characters, and forming theories. The discussions take place on the forums of westeros.org, as well as many subreddits. Fans maintain a healthy division between the narratives of ASOIAF and GoT, and discuss each differently. Most fans do not consume fan fiction because the author does not like it.



STAR WARS: FAN FILMS

Star Wars fans started making an increasing number of fan films, after the widespread availability of 3D and special effects software. There are even annual Star Wars fan film awards, with prizes given to different categories such as animation, special effects, action and comedy. George Lucas himself selects one film to get a special award. If you want to get in on the action, but do not want to invest your time or resources in making an entire film, Star Wars Uncut is a collaborative project that you can participate in. The original trilogy movies are divided into short clips, and fans are invited to submit their versions, produced any which way.

